

with professional associations. A new programme called 'Localisation Project Management Certification' for global website projects is also being offered.

Europe

In 2010, the Institute of Localisation Professionals headquartered in Dublin, Ireland launched a Certified Localisation Professional (CLP) programme comprising online and offline modules, and has trained a few hundred people. The programme is currently under revision. The Localisation Research Centre, part of the University of Limerick (Ireland) is offering a one-year M.Sc in Multilingual Computing and Localisation from the year 2011, in the distance education mode.

India

Several universities offer diploma and PG diploma courses in translation studies and linguistics. Students passing these courses found employment with government organisations and the media and served in translating administrative texts or literature/news. With the onset of liberalisation during the 1990s, the need for language professionals has grown rapidly, with India becoming the hotbed of IT outsourcing. During the last decade, the availability of computer operating systems and applications in Indian languages, and the rapid growth in the use of mobile phones and the Internet is further driving the market for language services. Most of you would have noticed the availability of Indian language user interfaces in ATMs, increased language options in Interactive Voice Response Systems and customer support centres of satellite television companies, besides the availability of English movies and television channels in Indian languages.

'Multilingual' magazine's December 2011 issue focused on opportunities in India. One reason mentioned for the small market for localisation is that the population that can afford to buy goods and services has a good knowledge of English, and would prefer to read material in English. However, the active involvement of the government through its Indian language initiative (Technology Development in Indian Languages); the focus of Google, Microsoft and other companies in their quest to reach a majority of the population; as well as the increased focus of the media and entertainment industries to serve Indians in their native languages, is ensuring that growth prospects in this domain are very attractive. Recent news reports mention the availability of enterprise applications in Hindi and other languages targeting the SME market in India.

The Indian government has started several initiatives to promote translation. The Institute of Translation Studies was set up in 2002 to promote offline and online education. The National Translation Mission Project was launched in 2008, with a target of translating knowledge texts into various Indian languages, and developing resources for improving translation in the country. It has published bilingual basic dictionaries of the most frequent words and phrases in several Indian languages. Punjab University

started a Centre for Language Innovation in May 2012, with the objective of education and research in languages, to promote skills development in the related areas.

All the above initiatives were focused on translation. It is heartening to note that the Department of Electronics and Information Technology Working Group has proposed to set up a National Localisation Research & Resource Centre (NLRRCC) during the 12th five-year Plan (2012-17). The objective is to spur localisation activities in India, with a focus on e-content in Indian languages, localisation of IT and non-IT products, localisation tools and platforms, standards development, as well as to promote entrepreneurship, incubation and Ph.D programmes.

Another important development is the launch of a professional association called the Indian Translators 3 Association in 2006, which is working with the government and others to organise the industry. The first international conference on the 'Role of Translation in Nation Building, Nationalism and Supra Nationalism' was held in New Delhi in 2010. The conference has become an annual event, and the association is also taking steps to introduce more professionalism into the industry.

In this brief article, we have reviewed the status of education and training in the broader area of language services. As can be seen, there is lot of growth potential in the language services market, and enterprising organisations and individuals can tap into this opportunity. 

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